

HP Dragonfly G4

Premium, private and pricey

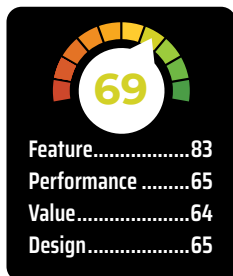
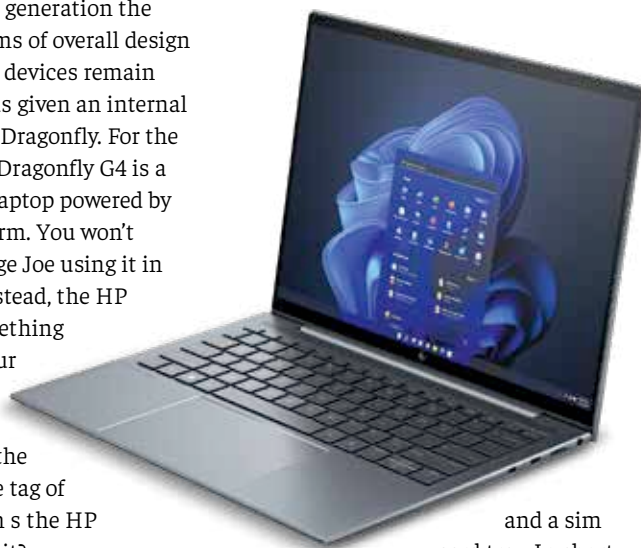
The HP Dragonfly G4 will remind you a lot of the previous generation the Dragonfly G3. In terms of overall design and aesthetics, both devices remain the same. But HP has given an internal upgrade to its latest Dragonfly. For the uninitiated, the HP Dragonfly G4 is a high-end premium laptop powered by the Intel vPro platform. You won't likely see your average Joe using it in Starbucks either. Instead, the HP Dragonfly G4 is something you'd hand out to your team of executives who are constantly on the move across the globe. With the price tag of around of Rs 2.3 lakh s the HP Dragonfly G4 worth it? Well, here's the answer.

DESIGN, KEYBOARD, TRACKPAD AND I/O

The HP Dragonfly G4, as mentioned above, looks similar to its previous generation. But that's fine. Mainly because it is a looker. The greenish-blue colour theme of the laptop finished in matte and the minimalist HP logo on the device's lid look very rich. You will also find subtle "DRAGONFLY" branding on the back letting the curious ones discreetly know the name of the laptop you're using.

The HP Dragonfly G4 also has curved sides, pointy edges and 16.5mm thickness. The 13.5-inch laptop also weighs 990g, making it highly portable. You can fit it and its USB Type-C charger in the smallest of handbags, without either of them taking up too much space. Despite its thin and small size, the laptop has an HDMI out port, two USB-C Thunderbolt 4 ports for charging and display out, a collapsible USB Type-A port, a headphone jack

₹2,36,494



and a sim card tray. In short, the I/O on this port is fantastic. And I am thankful to HP for not using a proprietary charging slot. The overall build quality of the HP Dragonfly G4 is good. You can open its lid with one hand because the laptop's base is well-balanced. The deck area is solid and devoid of flex. The laptop's keyboard is also worthy of equal praise. It features a 60% layout and is a joy to work on. The keys are squared, big, and have good travel to them. The button press is satisfying and yet the keyboard is virtually silent.

The 5MP webcam with an 88-degree field of view is another thing I'd like to mention here. It can capture more and in higher detail. It can clock photos in a 4:3 aspect ratio and can shoot videos in the same layout. However, if you want to switch back to the 16:9 aspect ratio you can do that as well. The webcam can record in 1440p at 30FPS. HP also has top-edge microphones and built in-AI features for blurring backgrounds and to make you sound

good during video calls. HP also has an auto-wake feature that automatically puts the laptop to sleep when you walk away from it and wakes it up as you come back. It is pretty neat and works without fail.

And the HP Dragonfly G4's trackpad is also a sheer joy to use. It is big, smooth and has probably the most satisfying click I have ever tested on a laptop. Every click on it feels immaculately accurate and blissfully delightful. Just an hour or two spent with the laptop made me realise why HP made no significant changes in the new design. The Dragonfly G4 is good the way it is, at least for now. The laptop also has a SIM card that supports 4G/LTE and 5G connections. And it is a great option for those who don't like to switch on their smartphone's hotspot every time they want to work.

What is also a great add-on to the laptop is a privacy filter. With the touch of a button, the Dragonfly G4's viewing angle reduces drastically. Thus only allowing whoever is sitting in front of the screen to see what's really happening on it. Although you can still barely see the display from the side of the screen brightness is full. But it is a good feature that I'd love to see getting more refined in the future. Further adding to the privacy features are a webcam shutter and a mic shutoff switch.

SCREEN AND SPEAKERS

The 13.5-inch display on the HP Dragonfly G4 is an unusual format. Instead of the usual 16:9 and 16:10 formats we see on laptops. The HP Dragonfly G4 comes in an exquisite 3:2 aspect ratio which gives the display a lot of height. The main benefit of such a design is increased productivity as now you can fit more of the document on your screen and don't need to constantly scroll up or down. What I tested was the IPS LCD FHD+ panel with a 1280P max resolution support and 60Hz refresh rate.

Moreover, in Calman display tests the screen's peak brightness